that they are making an heirloom that can be passed to further generations, so give the chair some thought and have fun!

Now as you will understand, this project is a fairly large one so we've decided to split it into two articles. This first one is the shaping of the seat and the turning of the four legs, two side stretchers and one centre stretcher. Next issue we will work on the top of the chair, the eight turned arm supports and the three piece arm.

The seat I'm using is a solid piece of ash (*Fraxinus excelsior*) but to find a piece of timber this size is very difficult, so you may want to join some boards together. Alternatively, you could scale down my measurements and make a child's chair instead. I'm also using ash for all the other components but again you could mix and match, as very often Windsor chairs would have been made from several timbers. Ash and yew (*Taxus baccata*) bend very well so were often used in steam bending, whereas elm (*Ulmus procera*) was often used for the seat.

INFORMATION AND PLANS

EQUIPMENT USED

- 9mm MDF for templates
- Bradawl
- Meter rule
- Bandsaw or jigsaw
- Angle grinder
- Carving blades for angle grinder
- G clamps
- Flat spokeshave
- Convex spokeshave
- Plane
- Cabinet scraper
- 25mm Forstner bit
- 20mm Forstner bit
- Dividers
- Callipers

CUTTING LIST FOR LEGS AND STRETCHERS

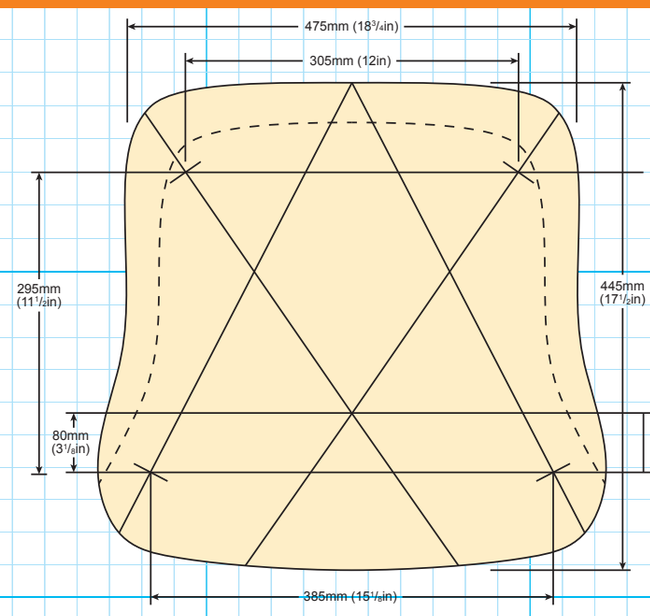
- 4 x legs 460 x 50 x 50mm – tenon diameter 25mm
- 1 x centre stretcher 420 x 50 x 50mm – tenon diameter 20mm
- 2 side stretchers 380 x 50 x 50mm – tenon diameter 20mm

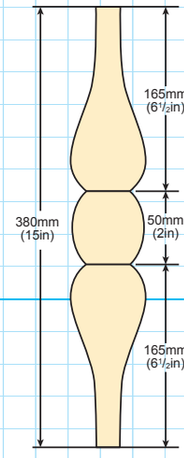
MAKING SEAT TEMPLATES

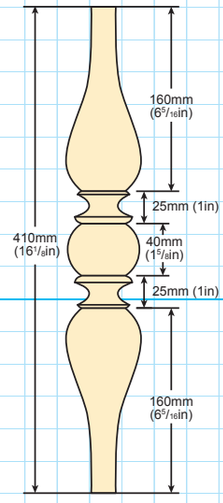
I've included all the measurements and I'd advise you to pencil in the dimensions of all the other components like the legs, stretchers and arm supports as well. I'm using 9mm MDF for all the templates, but plywood would work equally well. If you are only making one chair, thick cardboard would have the same effect.

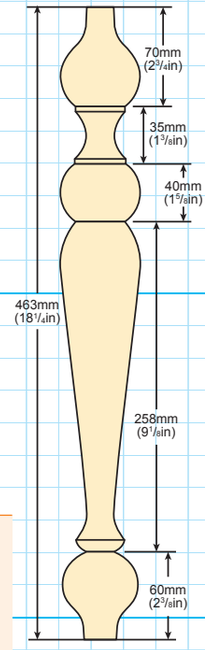
EXPLANATION OF SIGHT LINES

- The site lines on our seats enable us to get the correct splay on the chair legs
- The splay is the amount of angle the legs protrude when looking straight at the chair
- The hinge board and risers give you the leg angle when looking from the side of the chair
- This chair is designed to give a lounge feel or a Sunday morning peaceful paper reading feel, if you know what I mean!









HINGE BOARD

The hinge board lets you create which ever angle you want with the use of risers. The one I'm using is made up from bits we've found from old machines: two pieces of plywood or MDF connected at one end with a couple of hinges. You could make one easily using a drilled mortice at one end and a mortice cut in half the other to act as a cradle.

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